MODULE 26 · DOMAIN 7 - TROUBLESHOOTING AND OPTIMISATION

Feedback Loops and Workflow Optimisation

The feedback cycle, handling feedback, measuring before optimising, finding the bottleneck, and changes that matter.

DOMAIN 7 of 7 EXAM WEIGHT 10% MODULE 26 of 33

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Improve on evidence, one cycle at a time.

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The feedback cycle

01
Capture
Specific feedback from reviewers.

02
Translate
Into one or two changes.

03
Run
The next cycle with the change.

04
Compare
With the last cycle, on the same measures.

05
Document
What changed, and what happened.

06
Decide
Keep, adjust, or stop.

ON THE EXAM

One or two changes per cycle. Compare before you decide.

Where feedback comes from

SOURCE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Reviewer change logs	What people fix every time, and where the setup is weak
Client responses and complaints	What reached the reader, and how it landed
Usage analytics (Owners, on Team)	Who uses what, and how often
Time sampling	How long each step really takes
Direct comments	What readers want, once clarified

THE TIEBREAKER

Comments are one source. The quietest, most reliable source is what reviewers keep changing.

Building feedback into the workflow

- **Make it effortless:** a two-question note at the review gate. What did you change, and why?
- **Collect on a rhythm:** a short monthly review with the measures on one page.
- **Keep a change log** beside the Project: date, change, reason, result.
- **Name an owner** who runs the cycle and makes the keep, adjust or stop call.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> If giving feedback takes effort, you only hear from the angriest readers.

Turning comments into changes

COMMENT	CLEAR ENOUGH?	CHANGE
"Make it punchier"	No: ask what it means	After asking: lead with the key figure
"Too long"	Partly: how long is right?	Cap at two pages
"The numbers look off"	No: which numbers?	Trace them; check the calculation step
"Love the exceptions section"	Yes	Keep it, and note why

THE TIEBREAKER

Every comment maps to a specific change, a question, or a deliberate "keep".

Handling feedback well

- **Clarify ambiguity before acting.** A guessed meaning is a guessed change.
- **Map each comment** to a specific change, or record why there is none.
- **Resolve contradictions with the owner,** not by splitting the difference.
- **Prioritise by impact,** and tell reviewers what changed because of them.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Feedback is data. Treat it with the same care as any other input.

Contradictory feedback

AVOID

Splitting the difference

- North manager: more site detail
- Finance director: one page only
- Average it: a medium report
- Now neither reader is served

DO

Resolve with the owner

- Name the conflict, with both comments
- The report's owner sets the priority
- Often a structure serves both
- One-page summary, site detail in an appendix

THE TIEBREAKER

Do not average contradictory feedback. Take it to the owner, and look for a structure that serves both.

Measure before you optimise

MEASURE	EXAMPLE AT HALDEN	WHY
Quality	Reviewer corrections per report; errors reaching clients	Faster but worse is not better
Time	Minutes per step; total cycle time	Shows where the time really goes
Cost	Usage, rework, people's time	Shows whether a gain is worth it

ON THE EXAM

No baseline, no proof. Measure all three before changing anything.

The weekly report workflow, measured

STEP	MINUTES PER REPORT	SHARE
Export and clean the data by hand	120	56%
Claude calculates and drafts	15	7%
Manager reviews	45	21%
Corrections	30	14%
Send	5	2%

THE SIGNAL

The bottleneck is the step with the most time. Here, it is not the AI step at all.

Quirk 16, answered: the weekly report before and after

MEASURE, PER REPORT	BEFORE	AFTER THREE CYCLES
Export and clean data	120 min	10 min
Claude drafts	15 min	15 min
Review and corrections	75 min	35 min
Total time	215 min	65 min
Corrections by reviewers	About 6	About 1

THE SIGNAL

Same measures before and after: now the finance director has her proof.

Changes that matter, and busywork

CHANGES THAT MATTER

Move the measures

- Move repeated reference into a Project
- Add a short quality checklist
- Standardise the inputs
- Fix the bottleneck step

BUSYWORK

Feel productive

- Rewording a prompt that already works
- Switching models with no evidence
- Adding instructions nobody needed
- Tweaking after the criteria are met

ON THE EXAM

A change that matters moves quality, time or cost. Busywork moves nothing you measure.

Deciding after each cycle

- **Keep:** the measures improved, and nothing else got worse.
- **Adjust:** part of the gain arrived; refine the same change.
- **Stop and revert:** no gain, or worse. Back to the last good version.
- **Stop optimising:** the criteria are met. Keep measuring, and move to the next bottleneck.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> Knowing when to stop is part of optimisation.

Feedback and optimisation traps

THE TRAP	WHY IT FAILS
Applying every comment at once	Cause and effect vanish
Acting on "make it punchier" unasked	A guessed meaning, a guessed change
Averaging contradictory feedback	Serves neither reader
Optimising with no baseline	No proof of any gain
Speeding up the AI step by default	The bottleneck is often elsewhere
Tweaking after the criteria are met	Busywork that risks a working setup

ON THE EXAM

Every trap acts on a feeling instead of a measure.

> Halden's operations team has collected twelve comments from regional managers on this month's Claude-drafted weekly reports.

What is the best next step?

A Translate the comments into one or two specific changes, starting with the highest impact

B Apply all twelve comments to the prompt at once

C Rewrite the prompt from scratch

D Paste the comments in and let Claude apply them however it sees fit

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best next step?

A Translate the comments into one or two specific changes, starting with the highest impact

One or two changes keep cause and effect visible.

B Apply all twelve comments to the prompt at once

Twelve changes; no idea which mattered.

C Rewrite the prompt from scratch

Throws away what works.

D Paste the comments in and let Claude apply them however it sees fit

Hands the judgement away; changes go untracked.

THE SIGNAL

Many comments: translate into one or two changes, highest impact first.

> Halden's finance director says the weekly report "needs to be punchier". She gives no other detail.

What is the best response?

A Add "be punchier" to the Project instructions

B Ask her what punchier means: shorter, the key figure first, fewer sections? Then make that one change

C Cut every report in half

D Ignore the comment, since it is too vague to act on

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best response?

A Add "be punchier" to the Project instructions

Moves a vague comment into a vague instruction.

B Ask her what punchier means: shorter, the key figure first, fewer sections? Then make that one change

Clarify first, then one specific change.

C Cut every report in half

A guessed meaning, applied everywhere.

D Ignore the comment, since it is too vague to act on

Loses feedback from a key reader.

THE SIGNAL

Ambiguous feedback: clarify before you change anything.

> Halden's account managers paste the same rate card and brand guide into every chat. Some client letters still go out with old prices or off-brand wording.

Which two changes would make a meaningful improvement? Choose two.

A Move the rate card and brand guide into a shared Project's knowledge

B Reword the opening line of the prompt each week

C Try a different model each month to see what happens

D Add a short quality checklist the account manager completes before sending

E Change the font in the report template

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two changes would make a meaningful improvement? Choose two.

A Move the rate card and brand guide into a shared Project's knowledge

One current source, no pasting.

B Reword the opening line of the prompt each week

Busywork; the wording is not the cause.

C Try a different model each month to see what happens

Change with no evidence or hypothesis.

D Add a short quality checklist the account manager completes before sending

A gate that catches what slips through.

E Change the font in the report template

Moves nothing you measure.

THE SIGNAL

Repeated reference and errors reaching clients: a Project, and a quality check.

> Halden's operations director wants to optimise the weekly report process this quarter. No one has measured how long each step takes, or how many corrections reviewers make.

What should happen first?

A Rewrite the prompt for speed

B Buy more seats for the regional teams

C Measure current quality, time per step and cost, to set a baseline

D Ask Claude how the process should be optimised

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should happen first?

A Rewrite the prompt for speed

Optimises a step nobody has measured.

B Buy more seats for the regional teams

Spends money with no evidence of the problem.

C Measure current quality, time per step and cost, to set a baseline

Measure before you optimise.

D Ask Claude how the process should be optimised

Claude cannot see the process's numbers.

THE SIGNAL

No measures yet: set the baseline before changing anything.

> Measured per report: export and clean data 120 minutes, Claude drafts 15, manager review 45, corrections 30, send 5.
>
> The team proposes switching to a faster model to speed things up.

What is the best response?

A Switch to a faster model, as proposed

B Add a second reviewer to every report

C Shorten the manager's review time

D Fix the export and cleaning step, for example with a standard export format, since it holds the most time

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best response?

A Switch to a faster model, as proposed

Speeds up a fifteen-minute step.

B Add a second reviewer to every report

Adds time where none is needed.

C Shorten the manager's review time

Cuts the quality gate, not the bottleneck.

D Fix the export and cleaning step, for example with a standard export format, since it holds the most time

Targets the step that holds most of the time.

THE SIGNAL

The bottleneck is the slowest step, and here it is not the AI.

Halden's bid team is running a monthly improvement cycle on its tender-answer Project.

(1) Decide whether to keep, adjust or stop the change.

(2) Capture specific feedback from the bid writers.

(3) Run the next month's tenders with the change.

(4) Turn the feedback into one or two changes.

(5) Compare the results with last month, and document them.

What is the correct order?

A 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

B 4, 2, 3, 5, 1

C 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

D 2, 4, 5, 3, 1

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct order?

A 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

Capture, translate, run, compare and document, decide.

B 4, 2, 3, 5, 1

Changes before any feedback exists.

C 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

Runs before deciding what to change.

D 2, 4, 5, 3, 1

Compares before running the new cycle.

THE SIGNAL

Capture, translate, run, compare and document, then decide.

> On the weekly report, the North regional manager asks for more site-by-site detail. The finance director asks for one page only.

What is the best way to handle this?

A Split the difference, and produce a medium-length report

B Take both comments to the report's owner to set the priority, and propose a one-page summary with site detail in an appendix

C Follow whichever person is more senior

D Ask Claude to decide which feedback to follow

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best way to handle this?

A Split the difference, and produce a medium-length report

Serves neither reader.

B Take both comments to the report's owner to set the priority, and propose a one-page summary with site detail in an appendix

The owner decides; a structure can serve both.

C Follow whichever person is more senior

Seniority is not the same as ownership.

D Ask Claude to decide which feedback to follow

A priority call belongs to a person.

THE SIGNAL

Contradictory feedback: the owner decides, and structure can serve both.

> After three improvement cycles, Halden's weekly report meets every criterion. Reviewer corrections are close to zero.
>
> The team lead still wants to adjust the prompt wording every week.

What is the best next step?

A Keep tweaking the prompt wording every week

B Switch models to see whether results improve further

C Stop optimising this workflow, keep the measures as a monitor, and move effort to the next bottleneck

D Rewrite the prompt to make it shorter

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best next step?

A Keep tweaking the prompt wording every week

Busywork that risks a working setup.

B Switch models to see whether results improve further

Change with no problem to solve.

C Stop optimising this workflow, keep the measures as a monitor, and move effort to the next bottleneck

Criteria met: monitor, and move on.

D Rewrite the prompt to make it shorter

A change with no measured purpose.

THE SIGNAL

Criteria met: stop optimising, keep monitoring, move to the next bottleneck.

In five lines

- **The cycle:** capture, translate into one or two changes, run, compare, document, decide.
- **Handle feedback:** clarify ambiguity, map each comment, resolve contradictions with the owner.
- **Measure first:** quality, time and cost, before optimising anything.
- **Fix the bottleneck:** the slowest step, which is often not the AI step.
- **Changes that matter** move the measures. Stop when the criteria are met.

> COMING UP
>
> Next: the sequences the exam tests, all in one place.